

In This CORNER by bill hodge



FROM A GUY accustomed to winning pennants himself came the word Friday that Wichita was in good shape to win the American Association flag.

Andy Cohen, manager of the Indianapolis Indians whose old Denver Bears teams developed a pennant-habit in the Western League when Wichita and Denver both were members of that Class-A circuit, surveyed the situation Friday:

"Your club is in the best position it has been in for 10 days," he observed. "I won't say your club is 'in' but it is the next thing to it. Of course, we're going to try to beat it."



COHEN

Cohen pooh-poohed any idea that he might be trying particularly hard to beat Wichita out of old sentiment for Denver.

"We're hoping for fifth place," he said. "We want to beat anybody we can, no matter who they are. Fifth sounds a lot better than sixth. How did Omaha come out?"

The Indians right now are 1½ games off the pace of the fifth place Cardinals who were rained out in Minneapolis Thursday night.

Omaha has four games to go and Indianapolis, like Wichita, has but three.

LOSING TED BEARD knocked us out of the playoffs," the Indianapolis manager resumed.

"He was our spark, he gave everybody trouble."

Beard was recalled by the Chicago White Sox four weeks ago. He played a lot of outfield and hit among the Association's top six batters, in the neighborhood of .325 at Indianapolis.

Cohen was not surprised to hear that Norm Siebern, a 1956 Yankee and the Association's batting leader, had driven in the Bears' winning run in the nightcap against St. Paul at Denver Thursday night.

"It seemed like all he had to do was pick up a bat when we were in there the other day," the Indians manager said.

COHEN IS HIGH on the Wichita ball club too, though.

"Your club is solid," he was saying. "And I like the way it hangs in there. We had chances in both games last night but your team hung in there and won."

Although the Braves are down now to seven pitchers, Cohen still likes the club's staff.

"You've got the pitching," he said. "Fellows like (Carlton) Willey—he's a strong boy—and (Joe) Jay and (Red) Murf and (Vic) Rehm. You've still got pitching."

Like all managers in the minors, now-a-days, Cohen pays about as much heed to that attendance figure at the bottom of box scores as he does to who is pitching against him the next night.

He was pleased to hear that Denver had drawn over 9,000 fans for its twin bill with St. Paul.

Wichita attracted 4,046 Thursday night for playing two with Indianapolis.

"We got hot at home and beat Wichita (four of five)," Cohen said. "I think maybe it was a good

thing for everybody. The pennant race is making them draw at Denver and I think that had something to do with the crowd that saw us last night. It's nice to be able to draw when you're in sixth place like we are."

He returned then to thinking about taking fifth place away from Omaha.

The "magic number" for Indianapolis in its bid for fifth now is "6" to clinch and "5" to tie.

You'd like to wish luck to a nice guy like Andy Cohen but you can't in the situation which exists. Fifth place for Indianapolis means second place for Wichita.

So about the only thing that Cohen's many Wichita friends can hope for is that he has a Merry 1958.

Embittered at Political Hollywood Ow To Concede P

HOLLYWOOD, Sept. 6 (AP)—The Hollywood Baseball Club is through for the year on its home grounds and indications are strong that the Stars are gone forever.

But the man who made the club, President Robert H. Cobb, is not ready to board up the boxoffice, hang crepe over the door or sell his ball players.

In other words, he isn't surrendering until he sees the whites of the Brooklyn Dodgers eyes: until the Dodgers finally and officially take up residence in Los Angeles.

Bob Cobb quite understandably grows misty and sentimental when he thinks about his club, and he is also a little bitter about the situation.

Not about the advent of major league baseball. He's in favor of it. Yet he feels strongly that if all the politicians who have jumped on the Big League bandwagon had shown just a small bit of enthusiasm for the Pacific Coast League, a going concern over the last half century, things today would be different.

Twenty years ago Cobb and the late Victor Ford Collins led a move to buy the old Mission club from San Francisco, and thus gave birth to the Hollywood Stars.

Cobb, a restaurant owner, was not a baseball man. His critics intimated he didn't know the exact location of first base, and maybe he didn't.

They said Cobb and his Hollywood associates would soon tire of baseball, that it was merely a fad.

How wrong they were. In 20 years Cobb, a busy man socially and professionally, has rarely missed a home game. Often he made the road trips.

There's no estimating the hours and personal expense Cobb put out for baseball meetings—PCL, Minor and Major League conventions.

And until only the past few years, under a new setup with Pittsburgh, neither Cobb nor his fellow officials drew a cent in salary.

Actually, Cobb disclosed, stockholders have never got their original investment back.

"Regrets? No. I feel we have done something for the community. I hope we have helped a few kids to live clean lives. I've